Lab 03: Brush and Texture Library

Level: Foundation Suggested time: 60 minutes Platform: Complete the core brief in either Procreate or Sketchbook Studio; use the comparison notes to transfer the workflow. Alignment: K2 | K5 | LO1

Scenario

A sustainable packaging studio wants a small repeatable texture kit for paper, ink and foliage.

Your role: Surface-design assistant Required deliverable: A brush specimen board and a reusable three-brush mini library.

Learning goal

Apply Brush families | pressure response | grain | spacing | texture to a real design decision and produce evidence that meets explicit acceptance criteria.

Visual reference

!Original course visual

This is an original concept visual generated for this course. Analyse it; do not reproduce it as your submission.

Before you begin

- Use an iPad that supports your chosen app and a compatible stylus where available.
- Save an editable, layered master before exporting a flattened image.
- Use only owned, licensed or clearly permitted reference images and record their sources.
- Create a folder named Lab-03-<YourName> for working files and evidence.

Part A - Plan and construct

1. Translate the packaging brief into three texture jobs: paper tooth, dry-ink edge and foliage scatter.
2. Create a 3200 × 1800 px specimen board with twelve equal zones and blank caption areas.
3. Choose a neutral value so edge, opacity and grain-not colour-drive the comparison.
4. Test each candidate brush at slow/fast speed, light/heavy pressure and small/large size.
5. Select three brushes with non-overlapping roles; reject attractive marks that do not solve a job.
6. Apply the three selected textures to a simple packaging mock surface without changing its value hierarchy.
7. Name and save the specimen, the reusable brush set where the app permits, and a PNG proof.

Part B - Procreate pathway

1. Duplicate candidate brushes before changing settings in Brush Studio.
2. Compare Stroke Path spacing, Shape, Grain and Apple Pencil pressure response.
3. Name three duplicated brushes by job, e.g. TI Paper Tooth, TI Dry Ink, TI Foliage.
4. Organise them in a small custom Brush Set.
5. Paint specimen tests on separate named layers and record the settings that materially changed the mark.
6. Use Alpha Lock or a Clipping Mask to apply texture within a packaging shape.

7. Export the board and one close-up proof at final viewing size.

Part C - Sketchbook Studio pathway

1. Choose three existing brushes with clearly different jobs; Sketchbook Studio does not require custom-brush creation for this lab.
2. Vary size, opacity and pressure to build multiple roles from each brush.
3. Use separate layers for paper, ink and foliage textures and test per-layer opacity.
4. Duplicate a texture layer before trying a filter effect such as Mono, Vibrant or Soft Blur.
5. Use lock/hide controls to compare raw and filtered texture.
6. Apply the chosen textures to a simple package shape on separate layers.
7. Save the layered sketch and export the specimen board.

Evidence and acceptance checklist

[ ] Specimen board compares edge, opacity and grain

[ ] Three brushes have distinct roles

[ ] Texture remains subordinate to value

[ ] Brush choices documented

[ ] Layered working file is saved and opens correctly.

[ ] Final export uses a clear filename and matches the intended dimensions.

[ ] At least one in-progress screenshot shows the technique in use.

[ ] Reference sources and design decisions are recorded.

Peer review questions

1. Which brush solves structure versus atmosphere?
2. When does texture become noise?
3. How would the set change for a small mobile graphic?

Debrief

Use the Observe → Interpret → Connect → Propose pattern:

1. Observe: State what is visible without praise or blame.
2. Interpret: Explain the likely effect on attention, meaning, emotion or use.
3. Connect: Link the effect to the brief, a design principle or the acceptance criteria.
4. Propose: Name one specific change and how you will check whether it works.

Record one decision you will keep, one change you will test, and one technique you can transfer to the other app.

Troubleshooting

- The line feels wobbly: Zoom out, slow the decision rather than the stroke, use shoulder movement, and increase stabilisation only enough to preserve intent.
- Colour leaks during fill: Close the contour, inspect gaps at 100%, or place colour on a separate layer and clean with the precise eraser.

- The file becomes hard to edit: Name or document layer roles, hide unused experiments, group related stages and duplicate before merging or filtering.
- The image looks muddy: Check value grouping, lower overlay opacity, remove competing texture and restore one clear focal contrast.
- Perspective feels wrong: Return to horizon and vanishing logic; correct the large box before windows, props or decoration.

Submission package

Submit Lab-03-<YourName>/ containing:

- layered working file (or the app's saved layered sketch);
- final PNG/JPEG/PDF as required by the brief;
- progress evidence/contact sheet;
- short design rationale answering the peer-review questions; and
- reference/provenance list.

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